Model Question Paper

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP(HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION 2026

Fifth SEMESTER (DSE)- MG5DSEENG301 – Postcolonial Literatures

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. Which of the following best describes the three distinct periods of decolonisation identified in McLeod's essay? [CO 1] [K]
   a) 1776 American independence; 1867–1931 dominion formation; post-1947 majority-rule independence
   b) Fifteenth-century exploration; eighteenth-century settlement; twentieth-century independence
   c) Pre-WWI, inter-war and post-WWII periods
   d) African, Asian and Caribbean decolonisation movements

2. What was the main problem with early 'Commonwealth literature' criticism? [CO 1][K]
   a) It ignored the literary value of non-Western writers.
   b) It judged literature mainly through universal themes rather than specific historical and cultural contexts.
   c) It excluded writers from Australia and Canada.
   d) It concentrated excessively on anti-colonial resistance.

3. What does Paul's final promise to educate Dikeledi's children reveal about his character? [CO 3][K]
   a) Communal responsibility

b) Personal ambition
c) Social authority
d) Male superiority

4. Explain what a “balance of stories” primarily promotes. [CO 4][U]
   a) One authoritative account
   b) Multiple perspectives
   c) Positive stereotypes
   d) Historical silence

5. Igbo proverbs in the novel are described as: [CO 4] [K]
   a) Meaningless decorations in speech
   b) "The palm-oil with which words are eaten"
   c) Songs sung only by women
   d) Colonial imports

6. Which commission is mentioned as placing value on native tongues in West Africa? [CO 2] [K]
   a) Bernard Committee?
   b) Phelps-Stokes Commission
   c) Scottish Education Board
   d) British Advisory Committee

7. The white woman who appears to Makak on Monkey Mountain tells him that he: [CO 2] [K]
   a) Should leave the island and go to Africa
   b) Is descended from African kings and a member of a family of lions
   c) Will die within the year
   d) Must build a temple on the mountain

8. Okonkwo's harshness toward his son Nwoye is largely driven by his fear of: [CO 4] [U]
   a) Poverty
   b) Resembling his "weak" and "effeminate" father, Unoka
   c) Losing his farmland
   d) The missionaries

9. What does Adoja achieve that changes her grandmother’s perspective? [CO3][K]
   A. She learns to cook
   B. She wins a singing competition
   C. She becomes a district junior athlete champion
   D. She leaves the village to work

10. According to Ania Loomba, the term "postcolonial" does not simply mean "after" colonialism because: [CO3][K]
   A. Colonialism never actually existed historically
   B. Colonial power structures, knowledge systems, and racial ideologies continue to influence the world today
   C. All countries have successfully returned to their pre-colonial lifestyles
   D. Transnational corporations have completely vanished

(10X 1 =10)

Part B

SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. Explain the ways in which colonial power influences and colonises the minds of the oppressed, with reference to Fanon's works. [CO 1] [U]
12. Explain how the poem "Once Upon a Time" presents social conformity as a cause of emotional alienation. [CO 2] [U]
13. Examine how the references to Macaulay and Shakespeare reflect the effects of colonial education in the poem "Diwali". [CO 2] [An]
14. Compare the educational policies regarding language in Kenya versus Ghana during the colonial period. [CO 2] [An]
15. Explain how Lawino's portrayal of Clementine question Westernised ideas of beauty in "My Husband's Tongue is Bitter" ? [CO 3] [U]
16. Demonstrate how education functions as a source of hope and social mobility in Dikeledi's life and in Banabothe's future as discussed in "The Collector of treasures". [CO 3] [A]
17. Examine the significance of Mourid Barghouti's idea of beginning a story with "secondly" in Adichie's discussion of historical representation. [CO 4] [An]
18. Appraise the significance of the novel's title, *Things Fall Apart*, drawn from W. B. Yeats's poem "The Second Coming." [CO 4] [E]
19. Apply your understanding of *"The Girl Who Can"* to explain how Adjoa's legs, initially considered a defect by Nana, eventually prove their usefulness. How does this change demonstrate the contrast between traditional beliefs and modern values? [CO3][A]

(5 X 6 =30)

Part C

ESSAY QUESTION

Answer any 2 questions .Each question carries 15 marks

20. Discuss how the concept of "writing back" challenges the linguistic authority of the colonial centre. [CO 1] [U]
21. Assess the role of language in the play *Dream on Monkey Mountain*, particularly the distinction between standard English spoken by authority figures and the Creole dialect spoken by common people. What does this linguistic divide suggest about power and identity? [CO 2] [An]
22. Discuss the significance of *Things Fall Apart* as a foundational text in postcolonial literature. [CO 4] [E]
23. Apply your understanding of early colonial travelogues and maps to explain how they feminised physical landscapes by depicting them as passive, naked women, while portraying the act of geographical exploration as one of sexual mastery and conquest. [CO3] [A]

(2 X 15 =30)